Metro Lakes Watershed District

Monitoring and protecting the lakes, ponds and streams of our member cities

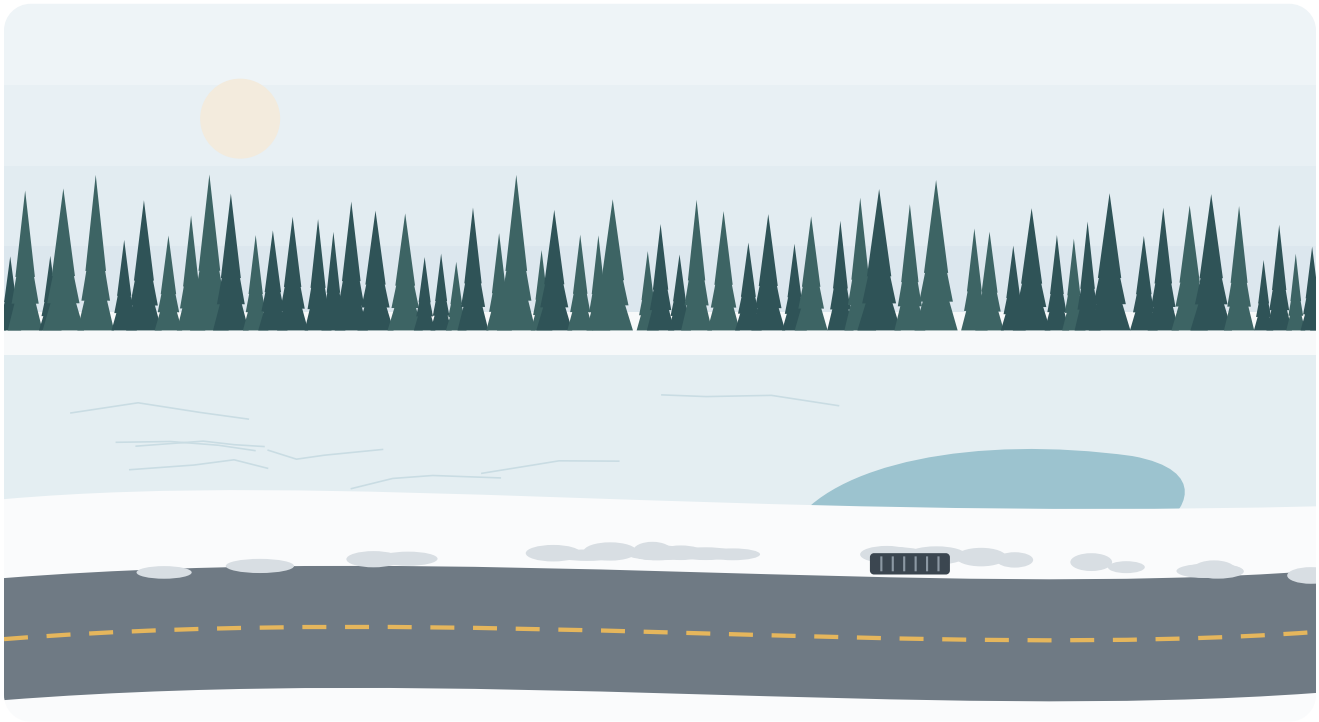
2027 Draft Budget

Proposed budget and property tax levy for the year beginning January 1, 2027

DRAFT FOR PUBLIC COMMENT

Posted September 2, 2026. Written comments are accepted through Friday, October 30, 2026, at metrolakeswd.org/budget/comment. All figures are preliminary until the Board of Managers adopts the 2027 budget; the Board will consider the final budget at its November meeting.

2027 draft budget	Proposed property tax levy	District staff
$3,166,000	**$2,748,000**	**8.95 FTE**
+5.4% from 2026 adopted	+5.3% from the 2026 levy	+0.75 FTE from 2026



Prepared by district staff for the Board of Managers

metrolakeswd.org/budget/2027-draft

Contents

1. Budget overview 3
2. Budget summary 4
2.1 Revenues and the levy 5
2.2 Spending by category 6
3. Water quality 7
3.1 Lake and stream monitoring 7
3.2 Chloride management 8
Table 3-2. Chloride management line items (scanned page) 9
3.3 Lake management 10
4. Capital projects 11
5. Administration 12
6. Staffing and reserves 13
Appendix A. Expenditure history, 2021 to 2025 (scanned page) 14
Appendix B. Budget calendar 15
Appendix C. Glossary 15

About this draft

This draft, posted for public comment on September 2, 2026, sets out what the district proposes to spend in 2027 on water quality, capital projects and administration, and how it proposes to pay for that work, mainly through its property tax levy. All figures are preliminary. The Board of Managers will consider the final 2027 budget at its November meeting and may change any figure in this draft.

How to comment

Written comments are accepted through Friday, October 30, 2026, at metrolakeswd.org/budget/comment, and are shared with the Board of Managers before it considers the final budget.

Reading the tables

- **2025 actual:** spending and revenue in 2025, as reported in the district's audited financial statements.
- **2026 adopted:** the budget the Board of Managers adopted for 2026.
- **2027 draft:** the budget proposed in this document.
- **Change:** the 2027 draft compared with the 2026 adopted budget, in dollars and percent.
- Amounts are in whole dollars. FTE means full-time equivalent staff positions.

Two tables are reproduced as scanned pages: Table 3-2, the chloride management line items (page 9), and Table A-1, expenditures by program and line from 2021 to 2025 (page 14). A text version of either table is available on request under the district's data-request policy at metrolakeswd.org/data-request.

1. Budget overview

The 2027 draft budget totals $3,166,000, an increase of $161,000, or 5.4 percent, over the 2026 adopted budget of $3,005,000. The draft proposes a property tax levy of $2,748,000, up $138,000, or 5.3 percent.

Highlights

- **Water quality: $1,031,000, up $218,000.** Most of the increase is in the chloride management line, which adds a chloride program specialist and two more Phase 3 storm sewer inlet stations (Section 3.2 and Table 3-2).
- **Capital projects: $1,366,000, down $84,000.** Construction of the Haskell Pond iron-enhanced sand filter begins as the Corliss Lake shoreline project finishes.
- **Administration: $769,000, up $27,000, or 3.6 percent,** mainly for salaries, insurance and the annual audit.
- **Staffing: 8.95 full-time equivalents, up 0.75.** The increase is the new chloride program specialist, budgeted from April 2027.
- **Reserves:** the draft uses $158,000 from the capital reserve for the Haskell Pond project. The unassigned fund balance stays above the district's policy minimum (Section 6).

Why the water quality program grows

Chloride from road salt does not break down, and once it reaches a lake there is no practical way to take it back out. The district's answer is prevention and monitoring: training the people who apply salt, helping them buy equipment that puts down only what a road or parking lot needs, and measuring chloride in lakes and in the storm sewers that feed them.

The first season of Phase 3 monitoring, in 2025, showed that snowmelt carries chloride into lakes in short, concentrated pulses that lake samples taken every four weeks do not catch. The draft adds two inlet stations to measure those pulses at more lakes, and staff time to expand Smart Salting training before the 2027-28 winter.

Other changes

Contract laboratory prices rise 3 to 4 percent, and salary and benefit costs for existing positions rise about 3.5 percent. State grants fall by $30,000: the 2026 grants support the Corliss Lake project, and the 2027 amount is for the Haskell Pond project. Interest income is budgeted lower, at $41,000, because reserve balances fall while Haskell Pond is under construction.

What the draft does not change

Sampling at the eight open-water lake sites continues every four weeks through the year, including under the ice when conditions are safe. The member-city stormwater cost-share program continues, and the Board of Managers' per diems stay at the 2026 level.

2. Budget summary

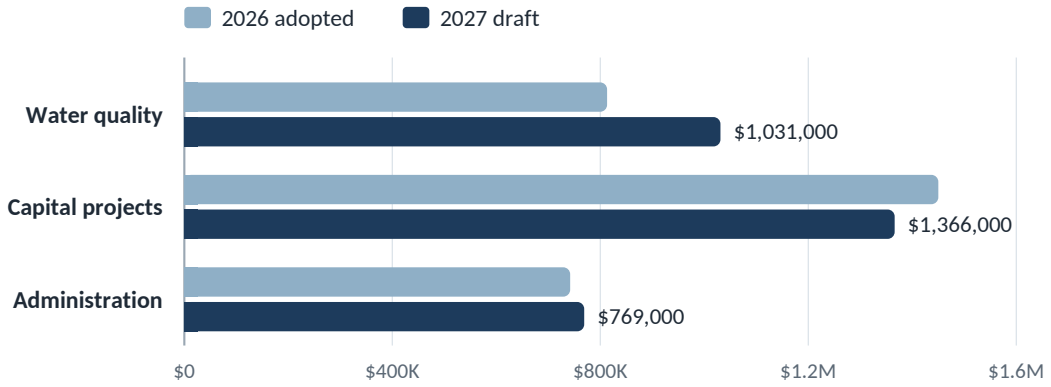
Table 2-1 shows spending by program and Table 2-2 shows how that spending is paid for. Figure 2-1 compares the 2027 draft with the 2026 adopted budget for each program.

Table 2-1. Expenditures by program

Program	2025 actual	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change	Percent
Water quality	874,748	813,000	1,031,000	+218,000	+26.8%
Capital projects	1,238,615	1,450,000	1,366,000	-84,000	-5.8%
Administration	711,086	742,000	769,000	+27,000	+3.6%
Total expenditures	**2,824,449**	**3,005,000**	**3,166,000**	**+161,000**	**+5.4%**

Water quality includes three budget lines: lake and stream monitoring, chloride management and lake management (Section 3).

Figure 2-1. Expenditures by program, 2026 adopted and 2027 draft



Bars start at zero. Values at the bar ends are the 2027 draft; Table 2-1 lists every value.

Table 2-2. Revenues and other sources

Source	2025 actual	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change	Percent
Property tax levy	2,479,612	2,610,000	2,748,000	+138,000	+5.3%
State grants	262,140	240,000	210,000	-30,000	-12.5%
Interest income	58,917	46,000	41,000	-5,000	-10.9%
Other revenue	11,206	9,000	9,000	0	0.0%
Total revenue	**2,811,875**	**2,905,000**	**3,008,000**	**+103,000**	**+3.5%**
Use of fund balance	12,574	100,000	158,000	+58,000	+58.0%
Total sources	**2,824,449**	**3,005,000**	**3,166,000**	**+161,000**	**+5.4%**

The 2025 levy figure is the amount collected in 2025. In 2026 and 2027 the use of fund balance comes from the capital reserve.

2.1 Revenues and the levy

The property tax levy pays for 87 percent of the 2027 draft budget. State grants, interest and other revenue pay for 8 percent, and the capital reserve for the remaining 5 percent.

The levy

The district levies a property tax on taxable property in its member cities. The proposed 2027 levy is $2,748,000, up $138,000, or 5.3 percent, from 2026. The levy rises less than spending because the draft uses more of the capital reserve for the Haskell Pond project.

The Board of Managers will certify a preliminary 2027 levy to the county auditor by September 30. The final levy, certified in December, may be lower than the preliminary levy but not higher.

Table 2-3. Property tax levy, 2022 to 2027

Year	Levy	Change from prior year	Percent
2022	2,241,000		
2023	2,318,000	+77,000	+3.4%
2024	2,402,000	+84,000	+3.6%
2025	2,486,000	+84,000	+3.5%
2026	2,610,000	+124,000	+5.0%
2027 proposed	2,748,000	+138,000	+5.3%

Levies as certified for each year. The 2027 amount is the levy proposed in this draft.

Grants, interest and other revenue

- **State grants: $210,000 in 2027,** a state Clean Water Fund grant toward the Haskell Pond iron-enhanced sand filter. In 2026, state grants support the Corliss Lake shoreline project.
- **Interest income: $41,000,** lower than in 2026 because reserve balances fall during Haskell Pond construction.
- **Other revenue: $9,000,** mostly reimbursements and fees for copies of district records.

Use of reserves

The draft uses $158,000 from the capital reserve, all of it for the Haskell Pond project. The district's reserves and its fund balance policy are described in Section 6.

When property taxes arrive

Property tax payments reach the district twice a year, in summer and in December. The district pays salaries, contracts and grants every month, so it keeps part of its fund balance as working cash between tax settlements.

2.2 Spending by category

Table 2-4 groups the same spending by type of cost rather than by program. It covers all three programs: water quality, capital projects and administration.

Table 2-4. Expenditures by category

Category	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change	Percent	Share of 2027
Personnel (salaries, benefits and per diems)	953,500	1,066,500	+113,000	+11.9%	33.7%
Contracted services and laboratory	456,600	516,700	+60,100	+13.2%	16.3%
Grants and cost-share	310,000	303,000	-7,000	-2.3%	9.6%
Capital outlay and one-time equipment	1,060,000	1,041,000	-19,000	-1.8%	32.9%
Operations, supplies and outreach	224,900	238,800	+13,900	+6.2%	7.5%
Total expenditures	**3,005,000**	**3,166,000**	**+161,000**	**+5.4%**	**100.0%**

Each line item is counted in the category that accounts for most of its cost.

Personnel

Personnel costs are salaries and benefits for district staff and per diems for the Board of Managers. They rise $113,000, or 11.9 percent, mainly because of the new chloride program specialist, budgeted from April 2027, and a 3.5 percent increase in salary and benefit costs for existing positions.

Contracted services and laboratory

Contract laboratories, consultants, legal counsel, the annual audit, general engineering, invasive species inspections and Smart Salting trainers. The increase reflects higher laboratory prices, more Smart Salting workshops, sampling at two new inlet stations and a one-time trend analysis of the Phase 1 chloride record.

Grants and cost-share

Matching grants to member cities for stormwater projects, and Smart Salting cost-share grants that help member cities and private applicators buy spreader calibration equipment. Stormwater cost-share is lower in 2027; Smart Salting cost-share is higher.

Capital outlay and one-time equipment

Construction of capital projects and one-time monitoring equipment, including the two new inlet stations. Capital outlay varies from year to year with the construction schedule (Section 4).

Operations, supplies and outreach

The district office, insurance, information technology, field supplies, printing and winter salt outreach.

3. Water quality

The water quality program measures the condition of the district's lakes, ponds and streams, works to keep chloride out of them, and manages aquatic plants and invasive species. It has three budget lines: lake and stream monitoring (3.1), chloride management (3.2) and lake management (3.3).

Water quality program

2026 adopted: $813,000. 2027 draft: $1,031,000. Change: +$218,000, or 26.8 percent. Most of the increase is in the chloride management line (pages 8 and 9).

3.1 Lake and stream monitoring

This line pays for total phosphorus, chlorophyll-a, water clarity and dissolved oxygen monitoring at the district's eight open-water lake sites, stream flow and biological monitoring, and the annual water quality report. Field visits serve both monitoring lines; their cost is split between this line and chloride management.

The 2027 draft keeps the same sampling schedule. Costs rise with contract laboratory prices and salaries. Field equipment returns to a normal level after the 2025 replacement of two sondes.

Table 3-1. Lake and stream monitoring line items

Item	2025 actual	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change
Staff, salaries and benefits (2.0 FTE)	206,118	214,000	221,500	+7,500
Contract laboratory: total phosphorus and chlorophyll-a	39,804	41,500	43,000	+1,500
Stream flow and biological monitoring	26,551	28,000	29,000	+1,000
Field equipment and supplies	17,212	14,500	15,000	+500
Annual water quality report and data management	8,761	9,000	9,500	+500
Total, lake and stream monitoring	**298,446**	**307,000**	**318,000**	**+11,000**

Phosphorus and clarity are measured at the open-water lake sites from June through September. Results are published each June in the district's water quality report.

How the program is organized

- **Lake and stream monitoring:** the condition of lakes and streams, reported every year.
- **Chloride management:** prevention and monitoring of chloride from road salt and other deicers.
- **Lake management:** aquatic plants and invasive species at district lakes.

3.2 Chloride management

Chloride from road salt and other deicers does not break down or settle out. Once it reaches a lake it leaves only with the water that flows out, and the district has no practical way to take it back out. The chloride management line therefore pays for two kinds of work: prevention, by helping the people who put salt down use less of it, and monitoring, to show whether prevention is working.

What the line pays for

- Monitoring at the eight open-water lake sites, sampled every four weeks through the year: the five Phase 1 lakes, monitored since 2019, and the three Phase 2 lakes added in 2022.
- The two Phase 3 stations added in 2025, the Lake Odegaard north inlet (a storm sewer outfall) and the Penner Lake outlet culvert. They are sampled while water is flowing, with added samples during snowmelt and after storms.
- Smart Salting training and certification for city street crews, school and park maintenance staff and private applicators.
- Cost-share grants that help member cities and private applicators buy spreader calibration equipment.
- Winter salt outreach to residents and businesses, and the chloride chapter of the annual water quality report.

What changes in 2027

- **A chloride program specialist.** The draft adds one full-time position, budgeted from April 2027, to run Smart Salting training and the cost-share program and to manage Phase 3 data. Staff time charged to the line rises from 1.50 to 2.25 full-time equivalents.
- **Two more storm sewer inlet stations.** Sites will be chosen in early 2027 from the district's inventory of storm sewer outfalls, and the stations are planned to be running before the 2027-28 winter.
- **More Smart Salting workshops and a larger cost-share pool,** to reach more private applicators, who treat parking lots, driveways and sidewalks.
- **A trend analysis of the full Phase 1 record** since 2019, by a contract statistician, for a future water quality report.

Why 2025 spending was higher than the 2026 budget

Actual 2025 spending on the line includes the one-time cost of installing the first two Phase 3 stations. Without that cost, 2025 spending was slightly below the 2026 adopted budget.

Where to find the figures

Table 3-2 on the next page lists each chloride management line item with its 2025 actual, 2026 adopted and 2027 draft amounts, and the basis for each estimate. Spending on the line in each year from 2021 to 2025 is in Table A-1 on page 14. Both tables are scanned pages.

3. Water quality (continued)

Table 3-2. Chloride management line items, 2025 actual, 2026 adopted and 2027 draft

Table 3-2 is reproduced as a scanned page of the district's 2027 budget worksheet, as presented at the Board of Managers' budget workshops. Amounts are whole dollars. The change column compares the 2027 draft with the 2026 adopted budget. Section 3.2 on page 8 describes the line.

METRO LAKES WATERSHED DISTRICT — 2027 BUDGET WORKSHEET

Program: Water quality — Budget line: Chloride management

Table 3-2. Chloride management line items

Whole dollars. The change column compares the 2027 draft with the 2026 adopted budget.

No.	Item and basis	2025 actual	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change 2026 to 2027
1	**Program staff, salaries and benefits** Coordination, Smart Salting, cost-share and Phase 3 data. 1.50 FTE in 2026; 2.25 FTE in 2027 with a new chloride program specialist budgeted from April 2027.	166,280	168,000	254,000	+86,000
2	**Routine monitoring, open-water lake sites** 8 sites, 13 rounds a year. $7,200 per lake in 2026; $7,400 per lake in 2027. Field time, contract lab and data review. No equipment.	55,712	57,600	59,200	+1,600
3	**Phase 3 stations ODG-IN and PEN-OUT** Sampling while water flows, with added snowmelt and storm samples; flow sensor upkeep; contract lab.	38,409	46,000	49,500	+3,500
4	**Phase 3 station installation** One-time, 2025: inlet flow sensor and sampler housings for the first two stations.	91,236	0	0	0
5	**Phase 3 expansion: equipment and installation** Two more storm sewer inlet stations. Sites to be selected in early 2027. One-time.	0	0	46,000	+46,000
6	**Phase 3 expansion: sampling and contract lab** First season at the two new stations.	0	0	21,000	+21,000
7	**Smart Salting training and certification** Workshops for city street crews, school and park staff and private applicators.	49,318	52,000	61,000	+9,000
8	**Smart Salting cost-share grants** Spreader calibration equipment for member cities and private applicators.	58,640	60,000	78,000	+18,000
9	**Winter salt outreach** Mailers, signs and paid media before and during winter.	15,104	16,000	20,000	+4,000
10	**Phase 1 chloride trend analysis** Contract statistician. Full Phase 1 record, 2019 onward.	0	0	12,000	+12,000
11	**Data management and reporting** Monitoring database and the chloride chapter of the annual report.	9,870	10,400	11,300	+900
	Total, chloride management	**484,569**	**410,000**	**612,000**	**+202,000**
	Percent change, 2026 adopted to 2027 draft				**+49.3%**

No. 2: about $7,400 per lake per year in 2027, all in (field time, contract lab and data review). Monitoring equipment is budgeted under lake and stream monitoring.

No. 4 and No. 5 are one-time costs. No. 4 was the 2025 installation of the first two Phase 3 stations, at the Lake Odegaard north inlet and the Penner Lake outlet culvert.

Funding: general levy. No. 5 may qualify for a state Clean Water Fund grant; no grant is assumed in this draft.

FTE: full-time equivalent. Staff time is charged to budget lines by timesheet.

DRAFT FOR PUBLIC COMMENT

A text version of this table is available on request under the district's data-request policy at metrolakeswd.org/data-request.

3.3 Lake management

This line pays for aquatic plant surveys and targeted treatments at district lakes, and for inspections of boats and trailers at public launches to keep aquatic invasive species out. Inspectors work weekends and holidays from the fishing opener through Labor Day.

Table 3-3. Lake management line items

Item	2025 actual	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change
Staff, salaries and benefits (0.5 FTE)	51,640	53,500	55,500	+2,000
Aquatic invasive species inspections at public launches (contract)	22,870	24,000	25,000	+1,000
Aquatic plant surveys and treatments	17,223	18,500	20,500	+2,000
Total, lake management	**91,733**	**96,000**	**101,000**	**+5,000**

Water quality work plan for 2027

- Sample the eight open-water lake sites every four weeks, including under the ice when it is safe, and the Phase 3 stations while water is flowing.
- Select, install and begin sampling two more storm sewer inlet stations before the 2027-28 winter.
- Hold Smart Salting workshops in the fall, before the 2027-28 winter, and award cost-share grants for spreader calibration equipment.
- Complete the trend analysis of the Phase 1 chloride record.
- Publish the 2026 Water Quality Report in June 2027.
- Inspect boats and trailers at public launches through the open-water season and survey aquatic plants at the lakes due for a survey in 2027.

Measuring results

The district reports on the water quality program each year in its water quality report and in its annual report to the Board of Managers. Chloride results are compared with Minnesota's chronic chloride standard for aquatic life, 230 milligrams per liter, as a screening check. Prevention is tracked through the number of people trained and the equipment funded through cost-share.

4. Capital projects

Capital projects reduce the phosphorus and sediment that stormwater carries to district lakes, and keep lake outlets working. They are planned in the district's capital improvement plan and paid for with the levy, state grants and the capital reserve. Chloride is not among the pollutants a capital project can remove: it dissolves in stormwater and passes through ponds and filters, so the district addresses it through the chloride management line instead.

Table 4-1. Capital projects, 2026 adopted and 2027 draft

Project	Purpose	Status	2026 adopted	2027 draft
Haskell Pond iron-enhanced sand filter	Dissolved phosphorus	Design 2026, construction 2027	180,000	640,000
Corliss Lake shoreline restoration and stormwater retrofits	Phosphorus and clarity	Final season 2027	620,000	210,000
Lake Ardell ravine stabilization	Erosion and phosphorus	Finishes in 2026	260,000	0
Kettle Lake outlet structure replacement	Lake level control	New in 2027	0	145,000
Member-city stormwater cost-share	Phosphorus and runoff volume	Matching grants	250,000	225,000
Capital program staff (0.9 FTE)	Salaries and benefits	Ongoing	98,000	101,500
Project engineering (consultant)	Design and inspection	Ongoing	42,000	44,500
Total, capital projects			**1,450,000**	**1,366,000**

The 2027 draft for the Haskell Pond project is paid for with a state Clean Water Fund grant, the capital reserve and the levy.

Table 4-2. Capital improvement plan, 2027 to 2031

Project	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031
Haskell Pond iron-enhanced sand filter	640,000	0	0	0	0
Corliss Lake shoreline restoration and stormwater retrofits	210,000	0	0	0	0
Kettle Lake outlet structure replacement	145,000	0	0	0	0
Sumac Lake shoreline buffer and swales	0	185,000	0	0	0
Little Tamarack Lake wetland restoration	0	90,000	460,000	0	0
Haskell Pond watershed retrofits, phase 2	0	0	0	520,000	380,000
Member-city stormwater cost-share	225,000	230,000	235,000	240,000	245,000
Capital program staff and project engineering	146,000	151,000	156,000	161,000	166,000
Total	**1,366,000**	**656,000**	**851,000**	**921,000**	**791,000**

Years after 2027 are planning estimates. They are not part of the 2027 budget and are reviewed each year.

5. Administration

Administration covers the Board of Managers, the district administrator, finance and records, communications and media relations, legal counsel, the annual audit, insurance and the district office.

Table 5-1. Administration line items

Item	2025 actual	2026 adopted	2027 draft	Change
Administrative staff, salaries and benefits (3.3 FTE)	386,214	402,000	416,000	+14,000
Board of Managers per diems and expenses	15,640	18,000	18,000	0
Office lease and utilities	82,105	84,000	86,500	+2,500
Legal services	41,377	45,000	45,000	0
Audit and accounting	36,900	38,000	40,000	+2,000
General engineering services	49,812	52,000	54,000	+2,000
Insurance	29,566	31,000	33,500	+2,500
Information technology and records	34,120	36,000	38,000	+2,000
Communications and public outreach	23,447	24,000	25,000	+1,000
Watershed management plan reporting	11,905	12,000	13,000	+1,000
Total, administration	**711,086**	**742,000**	**769,000**	**+27,000**

Changes in 2027

- Salaries and benefits for existing positions rise about 3.5 percent under the district's compensation plan.
- Insurance premiums rise $2,500, and the audit fee rises $2,000 under the current audit contract.
- Legal services and Board of Managers per diems stay at the 2026 level.

Public records and media requests

Requests for district data and records are handled under the district's data-request policy at metrolakeswd.org/data-request. Media questions go to the communications coordinator, Luis Ferreira (he/him), (651) 555-0158, luis.ferreira@metrolakeswd.org.

6. Staffing and reserves

Staffing

District staff are charged to programs by timesheet, so one person's time can appear in more than one line. The draft adds one position, a chloride program specialist, budgeted from April 2027; the 2027 figure counts it as 0.75 full-time equivalents.

Table 6-1. Staff by program, full-time equivalents (FTE)

Program or line	2025	2026	2027	Note
Lake and stream monitoring	2.00	2.00	2.00	
Chloride management	1.50	1.50	2.25	New specialist from April 2027
Lake management	0.50	0.50	0.50	
Capital projects	0.90	0.90	0.90	
Administration	3.30	3.30	3.30	
Total FTE	**8.20**	**8.20**	**8.95**	

Reserves

The district keeps a fund balance for two reasons: working cash between the two property tax settlements each year, and a capital reserve for planned projects. Its fund balance policy calls for an unassigned balance of at least 35 percent of the coming year's operating budget, which is the water quality and administration programs.

Table 6-2. Fund balance, 2025 to 2027

Fund balance, all district funds	2025 actual	2026 budget	2027 draft
Beginning balance, January 1	1,642,318	1,629,744	1,529,744
Plus revenue	2,811,875	2,905,000	3,008,000
Less expenditures	2,824,449	3,005,000	3,166,000
Ending balance, December 31	**1,629,744**	**1,529,744**	**1,371,744**
Of which, capital reserve	812,000	712,000	554,000
Of which, unassigned	817,744	817,744	817,744

The 2026 and 2027 columns assume revenue and spending as budgeted.

At the end of 2027 the unassigned balance would be $817,744, or 45 percent of the 2027 operating budget of $1,800,000, above the policy minimum. The capital reserve falls to $554,000 after the draw for the Haskell Pond project.

Appendix A. Expenditure history, 2021 to 2025

Table A-1. Expenditures by program and line, 2021 to 2025 (actual)

Table A-1 is reproduced as a scanned page of the district's financial system report of actual expenditures, which agrees with the audited annual financial statements. Amounts are whole dollars. Program lines follow the structure of the 2027 budget: water quality (lake and stream monitoring, chloride management and lake management), capital projects and administration.

METRO LAKES WATERSHED DISTRICT — **Table A-1**
EXPENDITURES BY PROGRAM AND LINE
FISCAL YEARS 2021 THROUGH 2025, ACTUAL (AUDITED)
WHOLE DOLLARS

PROGRAM / LINE	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	5-YR TOTAL
WATER QUALITY						
Lake and stream monitoring	256,104	268,733	279,520	288,917	298,446	1,391,720
Chloride management	296,815	339,402	352,118	366,970	484,569	1,839,874
Lake management	74,380	79,615	83,902	87,240	91,733	416,870
Water quality total	**627,299**	**687,750**	**715,540**	**743,127**	**874,748**	**3,648,464**
CAPITAL PROJECTS	**1,184,226**	**962,507**	**1,327,881**	**1,105,342**	**1,238,615**	**5,818,571**
ADMINISTRATION	**612,448**	**638,190**	**661,705**	**689,312**	**711,086**	**3,312,741**
DISTRICT TOTAL	**2,423,973**	**2,288,447**	**2,705,126**	**2,537,781**	**2,824,449**	**12,779,776**

NOTES
Chloride management includes chloride monitoring at all sites (Phase 1 from 2019, Phase 2 from 2022, Phase 3 from 2025), Smart Salting training and cost-share grants, winter salt outreach and program staff.
2025 chloride management includes the one-time installation of the two Phase 3 stations.
Capital projects vary with the construction schedule.
Amounts agree with the audited annual financial statements for each year.

*** END OF REPORT ***

Chloride monitoring began with Phase 1 in 2019; Phase 2 sites were added in 2022 and Phase 3 stations in 2025. A text version of this table is available on request under the district's data-request policy at metrolakeswd.org/data-request.

Appendix B. Budget calendar

Table B-1. Steps to a final 2027 budget

Date	Step
July 16, 2026	Board of Managers reviews the 2027 budget workshop schedule at its regular meeting.
Late July and August 2026	Board budget workshops on programs, capital projects and the levy.
September 2, 2026	Draft budget posted for public comment.
By September 30, 2026	Preliminary 2027 levy certified to the county auditor.
October 30, 2026	Written comments due.
November 2026	Board of Managers considers the final 2027 budget at its regular meeting.
December 2026	Final 2027 levy certified. It may be lower than the preliminary levy but not higher.
January 1, 2027	Budget year begins.

Written comments go to metrolakeswd.org/budget/comment. Comments received by October 30, 2026, are shared with the Board of Managers before it considers the final budget.

Appendix C. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Capital improvement plan	The district's five-year schedule of planned capital projects. Only the first year is budgeted.
Capital reserve	Fund balance set aside for planned capital projects.
Chloride	A salt ion that reaches lakes mainly from road salt and other deicers. It does not break down in water.
Chronic standard	Minnesota's chloride standard for sustained exposure of aquatic life, 230 milligrams per liter.
Cost-share grant	A district grant that pays part of the cost of a project or equipment purchase by a member city or other partner.
Fund balance	Money the district holds at the end of a year: working cash, reserves and amounts set aside for specific purposes.
FTE	Full-time equivalent. One FTE is one full-time position for a full year.
Levy	The property tax the district certifies each year to pay for its budget.
Phase 1, 2 and 3	The stages of the district's chloride monitoring: five lakes from 2019, three more lakes from 2022, and a storm sewer inlet and a lake outlet from 2025.
Smart Salting	District training and certification for people who apply salt, on using less salt while keeping surfaces safe.
Storm sewer inlet station	A monitoring station where a storm sewer empties into a lake. It measures what runoff carries in, including snowmelt pulses.

Metro Lakes Watershed District

Monitoring and protecting the lakes, ponds and streams of our member cities

Comment on the 2027 Draft Budget

- Written comments are accepted through **Friday, October 30, 2026**, at metrolakeswd.org/budget/comment.
- Comments received by the deadline are shared with the Board of Managers before it considers the final 2027 budget at its November meeting.
- The full draft, including the scanned Tables 3-2 and A-1, is posted at metrolakeswd.org/budget/2027-draft. A text version of either scanned table is available on request under the district's data-request policy at metrolakeswd.org/data-request.

Media contact

Luis Ferreira (he/him), Communications Coordinator, Metro Lakes Watershed District
(651) 555-0158 | luis.ferreira@metrolakeswd.org

About the district

The Metro Lakes Watershed District is a local unit of government led by a Board of Managers. It monitors and protects the lakes, ponds and streams of its member cities and is funded mainly by a property tax levy on property in those cities. Board agendas, budgets and reports are posted at metrolakeswd.org.